

5.5 The Best Free Games Available Today

Gaming has come a long way from Solitaire to giant graphic card killers such as *DOOM 3* and *F.E.A.R.* It's a multi-billion dollar industry that's growing faster each day.

Since most users do not have the requisite hardware needed for the latest generation of games, thousands of smaller games, which are addictive, and will run on almost any PC have popped up. Some are totally free, others are online Flash-based games, and even more are adware supported or time-limited. Gaming has taken over our cell phones, and almost all mobile phones available today support the Java platform, just so you can load games!

This section, deals with only freeware Windows-based games, and we have given the best we could find in each category. While the games reviewed here are not the only ones available; instead, think of them as our pick of the lot. Since tastes vary, you may have some other ideas about what the best freeware games are, and we'd love to hear your views, so write in and let us know.

We used the following system configuration to test all the freeware games:

AMD Athlon FX-53
1 GB DDR 3200 RAM
nVidia 6800 Dual-GPU graphics card
80 GB SATA hard drive

Overkill? You bet! Actually, this was the only system free at that moment in the Test Centre, not that the reviewers were complaining or anything!